



Based in San Francisco



EDUCATION

BSC ELECTRICAL & COMPUTER ENGINEERING

2016 – 2019 · University of Cape Town

- Graduated with First Class Honours as the top BSc(Eng) student.
- Awarded the prize for the best final-year thesis.

SKILLS

LANGUAGES & TOOLS

Go, Python, SQL, Git, Docker, gRPC

DOMAINS

Distributed systems · P2P networks · event-driven systems & pipelines · protocol design · database migrations · code review at scale

AGENTIC WORKFLOWS

Daily use of local parallel coding agents (Codex, Claude) · designing features and steering agents through implementation

Contact me for references.

Elle Mouton

Backend Software Engineer

ABOUT

I am a backend engineer with 5+ years building production-scale distributed systems. My work spans event-driven microservices serving millions of users and protocol-level upgrades to large, live peer-to-peer networks. I thrive in small, fast-moving teams with high ownership and high engineering standards.

I'm especially interested in agentic loops, building experiences, flows, and tools for both developers and non-developers, AI, and event-driven systems.

Outside of work, you can find me in the mountains, looking for rocks to climb, photo hunting, practicing calisthenics, or spending time with friends.

EXPERIENCE

⚡ Lightning Infrastructure Engineer | Lightning Labs

2021 – Present

One of the top contributors to [LND](#), the most widely-deployed Lightning Network implementation. My work centres on shipping protocol upgrades and large database migrations safely across a live peer-to-peer network of thousands of nodes. I also lead major features in the [Lightning Terminal](#) and [Lightning Node Connect](#) developer-tooling projects.

- Contributions to the Lightning Network protocol specification.
- Significant optimisations to the Neutrino (Bitcoin light-client) sync process.
- Extensive code review on a large, widely-used open-source codebase.

🌀 Software Engineer | Luno

2020 – 2021

Backend engineer on the crypto-operations team. Worked in Go on event-driven microservices handling high cryptocurrency volumes for millions of users.

WRITING

Deep-dive technical posts on Bitcoin and Lightning Network internals, widely read across the community. ellemouton.com/articles →

PUBLIC APPEARANCES



Advancing Bitcoin, London



Connect The World Podcast



The Chaincode Podcast



Bitcoin Optech Podcast



Bitcoin Optech Podcast



Bitcoin++ Brazil